CLASS XII HINDUSTANI MUSIC — VOCAL

Extremely Detailed Chapter-wise Notes

CBSE • Subject Code 034 • Theory + Practical Preparation

Expanded explanations, comparisons, tala counts, raga study, practical guidance, viva questions, and revision sheets.

Use with your current CBSE syllabus, prescribed textbook, and teacher’s classroom versions of ragas, bandishes, and notation.

How to use these notes

Purpose

These notes expand the CBSE Class XII Hindustani Music (Vocal), Subject Code 034, into a chapter-wise study guide. They explain the prescribed terminology, historical topics, talas, raga concepts, and practical examination preparation. Use them alongside your current CBSE syllabus, prescribed textbook, class notebook, and teacher's chosen bandishes.

Important accuracy note

Hindustani music has gharana- and teacher-specific variations in bandish, swara treatment, and performance practice. Where a composition's exact words or notation must be memorised, copy the version taught in class rather than relying on a generic version. The name "Krishna Rao" can be ambiguous in music-history references; verify the exact person intended by your prescribed textbook. Do not treat illustrative aroha/avaroha or pakad descriptions as a replacement for your teacher's raga grammar.

Suggested study method

For each theory topic, learn (1) a precise definition, (2) the musical process, (3) one clear example, (4) its importance, and (5) a short exam-ready answer. For practical work, keep a daily riyaaz log and record whether swara accuracy, laya, taal, voice steadiness, and raga identity remained clear.

Unit 1 — Musical terms and concepts

1. Alankar

Meaning: an ornament, embellishment, or patterned arrangement of swaras. In basic practice, an alankar is a deliberately designed swara pattern sung in a chosen scale or raga. Example in a simple shuddha-swara pattern: Sa Re Ga, Re Ga Ma, Ga Ma Pa, and so on. The pattern is not merely a scale sung up and down; it trains the voice to move through swaras in a controlled sequence.

Purpose and practice of alankars

Alankars develop swara placement, breath control, tonal steadiness, evenness across registers, clarity of pronunciation, and coordination with laya. Begin slowly with a tanpura or suitable drone. Keep each swara stable, avoid pushing the throat, and increase speed only when every note remains clear. Practise ascending, descending, and mixed patterns, but adapt the pattern to the prescribed raga's swaras; do not introduce forbidden or inappropriate swaras into a raga.

2. Kan

Kan is a very brief grace note that touches or suggests another swara while the main swara remains the centre of attention. It is usually quick and is not held for the same duration as a full swara. Its effect is subtle: it gives a note expressive colour without turning the grace note into an independent melodic stop. The exact approach and direction depend on the raga and the phrase.

3. Meend

Meend is a smooth, continuous glide from one swara to another. Instead of striking every intermediate pitch separately, the voice travels through the pitch space in a connected movement. Meend is essential to the expressive identity of many ragas. Practise it slowly, with relaxed breath and a steady tone; the destination swara must be clear. A forced or broken glide loses its musical smoothness.

4. Khatka

Khatka is a quick, compact ornamental turn in which the principal swara is surrounded or coloured by nearby swaras in a rapid movement. It produces a crisp, lively effect. It must be performed accurately and in keeping with the raga; a random cluster of notes is not a proper khatka. Keep the movement agile without tightening the jaw or throat.

5. Murki

Murki is a very quick, delicate cluster of swaras, often heard as a light curling or flickering ornament around a main note. It is generally lighter and more finely articulated than a broad, weighty gamak. Murki should sound graceful rather than heavy. Its shape is phrase- and style-dependent.

6. Gamak

Gamak is a forceful, oscillating or emphatic treatment of a swara or group of swaras. It gives weight, energy, and dramatic intensity. It is not simply singing loudly: the defining feature is the controlled, deliberate movement or oscillation of pitch. Gamak must be appropriate to the raga and style. Avoid throat strain; the movement should be supported by relaxed technique.

Distinguishing the ornaments

Kan: a fleeting grace touch. Meend: a continuous glide. Khatka: a brisk, compact turn. Murki: a delicate, rapid cluster. Gamak: a weightier, forceful oscillatory treatment. Alankar: a broader term for ornamentation or a patterned swara exercise. In an exam answer, define the term, describe the sound/movement, and state its musical purpose.

7. Gram

Gram is an ancient theoretical concept describing a foundational arrangement or collection of pitches in Indian music theory. In older treatises, grama is connected with the organisation of swaras and the theory of intervals. It belongs to the historical framework from which later systems of scales and melodic organisation developed. Explain it as a historical concept, not as a synonym for a modern raga.

8. Murchhana

Murchhana refers, in traditional theory, to a sequence beginning from different starting notes within a grama or pitch framework. Changing the starting swara changes the ordering and relationship of the notes. It is an important historical idea for understanding how ancient theorists thought about melodic structures. Avoid equating every murchhana directly with a modern thaat or raga; the systems are historically related but not identical.

9. Alap

Alap is the gradual, usually non-metrical exposition of a raga. The performer introduces the raga's important swaras, characteristic phrases, mood, and melodic movement without being bound to the regular cycle of a tabla tala in the same way as a composed bandish. Alap should reveal the raga step by step: begin in a comfortable register, establish the tonal centre, explore characteristic notes, and develop phrases with pauses and breath. It is not an arbitrary improvisation; raga grammar governs the notes and phrases.

10. Tana

A tana is a rapid melodic passage using swaras or syllables, usually demonstrating fluency, clarity, and command of laya. Tanas may use different patterns and directions, but they must preserve the identity of the raga. Speed alone is not excellence: swaras must be distinct, rhythmically accurate, and musically resolved. Build speed gradually from a slow, accurate pattern.

Exam-ready comparison: Alap and Tana

Alap develops the raga gradually and is generally expansive and comparatively unhurried; a tana is a fast, patterned melodic passage. Alap establishes mood and grammar; tana demonstrates agility and rhythmic control. Both are governed by the raga's swaras and characteristic movement.

Unit 2 — Historical development of the time theory of ragas

What is raga-time theory?

Raga-time theory is the traditional association of certain ragas with particular times of day or night. It is a system of aesthetic convention: the atmosphere of a raga is thought to harmonise with the light, emotional quality, and listening context of a time period. It is not a scientific law that a raga can only be sung at one time.

Why time associations developed

Indian musical thought has long connected sound, mood, nature, and human experience. The changing character of dawn, daytime, evening, and night offered a framework for grouping ragas. The theory also helped organise performance practice and created expectations for a concert's progression. Different historical writers and musical traditions explain the classifications in different ways.

Historical development — how to explain it

Older Sanskrit musicological texts discuss swara, grama, murchhana, jati, and melodic organisation in ways that form part of the long background of raga theory. Over time, the raga became a central melodic concept, with characteristic phrases, important notes, mood, and performance conventions. Later theoretical traditions increasingly systematised raga classification, including time associations. Modern Hindustani practice commonly teaches prahar-based groupings, while actual concert schedules, regional practice, and individual gharanas may differ.

Prahar system

A day and night are often divided into eight prahars, each roughly three hours long. The exact clock-time boundaries can vary with the system being taught and with sunrise/sunset conventions. For the exam, learn the time groups and examples specifically given in your textbook or by your teacher. Do not rely on a single internet chart when your school's prescribed chart may differ.

Traditional explanatory principles

Some teaching systems relate time classification to the position and treatment of swaras, especially the role of Re, Ga, Ma, Dha, and Ni and whether they are komal or shuddha. These explanations are theory-dependent and should be learned in the exact form taught in class. The safest exam method is to present the traditional principle, give the prescribed examples, and acknowledge that the system is a convention of raga aesthetics.

How to prepare a strong long answer

Start with a definition. Explain why time theory emerged. Mention the historical movement from older pitch/melodic theories toward developed raga classification. Describe prahars. Give two or three examples from the prescribed textbook. End by stating that time theory guides traditional performance but modern practice may adapt it. Use the names and timings from your official classroom material.

Common mistakes

Do not state that every raga has one universally agreed exact time. Do not confuse raga-time theory with tala or tempo. Do not claim that a raga's time association proves it is impossible to perform it at another time. Avoid memorising unsupported classifications that differ from the syllabus material.

Unit 3 — Historical texts and musicians

1. Sangeet Ratnakar

Sangeet Ratnakar is a major medieval Sanskrit musicological work associated with Sharngadeva, generally dated to the thirteenth century. It is important because it preserves a substantial account of music theory and practice from its period and is often treated as a bridge between earlier and later Indian musical traditions. It discusses subjects such as swara, shruti, grama, murchhana, jati, raga, tala, and performance-related topics. In a school answer, identify the author, period, importance, and major areas covered; follow your textbook for chapter-specific details.

Importance of Sangeet Ratnakar

The text is valuable to historians because it records ideas that help explain the evolution of Indian music. Its terminology and framework are not identical to every modern Hindustani concept, so it should not be read as if it were a contemporary beginner's manual. Its importance lies in the depth of its theoretical coverage and its position in music history.

2. Sangeet Parijat

Sangeet Parijat is an influential musicological treatise associated with Ahobala, commonly placed in the seventeenth century. It discusses musical theory and practice, including swaras and related concepts. It is often mentioned in

discussions of the historical development of Indian music theory and the evolving treatment of pitch and melodic organisation. For a school answer, learn the author, approximate period, central subject, and historical significance from the prescribed text.

Compare the two texts

Sangeet Ratnakar is a medieval work by Sharngadeva and covers a wide range of musicological subjects, including older theoretical systems and raga/tala. Sangeet Parijat is a later work associated with Ahobala and reflects a subsequent stage in the history of music theory. Both are important records of how Indian scholars described music, but they belong to different periods and should not be treated as identical in scope or terminology.

3. Ustad Faiyaz Khan

Ustad Faiyaz Khan (1886–1950) was a celebrated Hindustani classical vocalist associated with the Agra gharana. He was known for a powerful, resonant voice, strong command of khayal, and an approach that combined rhythmic force with melodic development. The Agra tradition is often associated with bol-baant, bol-taan, and a substantial treatment of the composition's words and rhythm. In an exam answer, focus on his gharana, vocal style, contribution to khayal, and lasting influence; verify dates and details against your textbook.

4. Ustad Bade Ghulam Ali Khan

Ustad Bade Ghulam Ali Khan (1902–1968) was one of the most admired Hindustani vocalists of the twentieth century and is associated with the Patiala gharana. He became known for a melodious, flexible voice, fluid taans, expressive phrasing, and an ability to combine technical brilliance with lyrical sweetness. His repertoire and performance style influenced generations of listeners and musicians. For the exam, learn his gharana, distinctive vocal qualities, major contribution, and the way his style balanced agility and expression.

5. Krishna Rao — verify the prescribed identity

The name "Krishna Rao" by itself may refer to more than one musician or scholar in Indian music history. The CBSE syllabus wording should be checked against the exact chapter and spelling in your prescribed textbook or teacher's notes before memorising a biography. Prepare a short profile containing full name, dates if given, gharana or institutional association, musical role, distinctive style, and contribution. Do not attach another person's achievements to this name merely because the names are similar.

6. Shankar Pandit

For Shankar Pandit, use the precise identity and biographical details given in your prescribed textbook. Similar names can appear in music history, and a school syllabus may refer to a particular vocalist, teacher, or scholar. Organise the answer under: identity and period; training or musical tradition; style or specialty; contribution to performance/teaching; and legacy. Confirm spelling and facts with your teacher rather than relying on unsourced summaries.

How to write musician biographies

A good five-mark biography usually includes: (1) full name and dates/period, (2) gharana or tradition, (3) training or background, (4) musical characteristics, (5) contribution, and (6) influence/legacy. Do not write only praise words such as "great" or "famous"; explain what made the musician distinctive. If exact dates are uncertain, omit them rather than inventing them.

Unit 4 — Talas, notation, and tanpura

1. Core tala vocabulary

Tala is a recurring rhythmic cycle. A tala has a fixed number of matras and a conventional arrangement of sections (vibhags), with claps (tali) and, where applicable, a wave (khali). The sam is the first and structurally most important beat of the cycle. Theka is the characteristic pattern of tabla bols used to articulate a tala. Laya means the speed or pace of musical movement; vilambit is slow, madhya is medium, and drut is fast.

2. Jhaptal

Jhaptal has 10 matras, commonly grouped 2 + 3 + 2 + 3. Its standard classroom hand-clap pattern is usually taught as tali on matras 1, 3, and 8 and khali on matra 6, with the precise hand gestures demonstrated by the teacher. A commonly taught theka is: Dha Dhi Na | Dha Tu Na | Ta Dhi Na | Dha Tu Na. Variants exist, so use the exact bol pattern prescribed in class.

Jhaptal counting

Count: 1 2 | 3 4 5 | 6 7 | 8 9 10. Speak the theka steadily while showing the vibhags. Practise reciting the 10 matras without tabla, then with theka, then with a composition. The goal is not merely to remember “10”; it is to feel the return to sam after each cycle.

3. Rupak tala

Rupak is commonly taught as a seven-matra tala divided 3 + 2 + 2. In a widely used Hindustani classroom convention, the first section is khali and the following sections are marked with claps; exact notation conventions should match your teacher’s system. A commonly taught theka is: Tin Tin Na | Dhin Na | Dhin Na. Some traditions and teaching resources show variants in bols and notation. Learn the version your teacher uses and make sure the count returns correctly to sam.

Rupak counting

Count: 1 2 3 | 4 5 | 6 7. Recite the bols evenly and mark the divisions clearly. Because Rupak begins with khali in the common convention, do not automatically assume every tala begins with a clap. Check the hand pattern in class.

4. Dhamar tala

Dhamar has 14 matras and is commonly divided 5 + 2 + 3 + 4. It is associated with the Dhamar form of singing, traditionally linked with the Holi season and themes of Krishna, although repertoire and performance context vary. A commonly taught theka is: Ka Dhi Ta Dhi Ta | Dha – | Ga Ti Ta | Ti Ta – – (bols and subdivisions may be represented differently in different teaching traditions). Follow the exact classroom notation.

Dhamar counting

Count: 1 2 3 4 5 | 6 7 | 8 9 10 | 11 12 13 14. Practise saying the cycle aloud with claps/waves, then recite the theka. Dhamar requires careful awareness of the unequal sections; do not flatten all 14 beats into an undifferentiated count.

5. Thah, dugun, tigun, chaugun

These terms describe the relationship between the rate of recitation and the basic pulse. Thah (also called barabar) is one unit per matra at the base rate. Dugun means two equal units in the time of one matra. Tigun means three equal units per matra. Chaugun means four equal units per matra. The cycle’s total number of matras does not change; the number of spoken/sung subdivisions changes.

Worked rhythm example

For a 10-matra cycle such as Jhaptal: in thah, count 10 matra-units; in dugun, fit 20 equal subdivisions across the same cycle; in tigun, fit 30; in chaugun, fit 40. Keep the main pulse steady. A common error is to speed up the tala itself instead of fitting more subdivisions into the same pulse. Practise by speaking the bols against a metronome or tanpura/tabla practice track, then return clearly to sam.

6. Tanpura: purpose and structure

The tanpura (tambura) provides a continuous drone that establishes the tonic and its tonal reference. It is not normally played as a melody instrument. Its sustained, overlapping sound helps the singer hear the relationship of sung notes to Sa and the chosen pitch centre. A standard tanpura has a resonating body, long neck, bridge, strings, tuning pegs, and a thread or jawari adjustment that affects the characteristic buzzing richness of the sound.

Tanpura tuning — safe method

First establish the singer’s comfortable Sa with a teacher, harmonium, electronic tanpura, or another reliable reference. Tune the main tonic string(s) to the intended Sa and the other strings to the prescribed drone notes used in your school’s setup, commonly including Pa or a suitable alternative such as Ma depending on the raga and tradition. Tune slowly, making tiny peg adjustments; pluck each string separately and listen for stable pitch and a balanced drone. Recheck after the strings settle. Do not force tuning pegs or overtighten strings. Because string order and tuning

arrangement vary, memorise the exact sequence demonstrated by your teacher.

Common tuning checks

The drone should sound steady, not wavering; strings should not buzz unintentionally against the bridge; the pitch should remain stable; and the combined sound should support rather than overpower the voice. If the string pitch is uncertain, use a reference rather than guessing. The correct choice of drone notes can depend on the raga and performance convention.

Notation fundamentals

In Hindustani notation, swaras are written with conventions for shuddha and vikrit notes, octave placement, and rhythmic duration. Different books use different symbols for komal/tivra swaras, octave marks, pauses, and matra values. Therefore, learn the symbol key printed in your prescribed book. When writing a bandish, include the sthayi and antara as applicable, mark the tala and sam, preserve the exact lyrics, and ensure that each swara aligns with the correct rhythmic position.

Unit 5 — Prescribed ragas

Raga: definition and components

A raga is a melodic framework with characteristic swaras, important notes, phrases, movement, and expressive identity. It is more than a scale. Two ragas may use similar notes but differ in emphasis, phrase shape, approach to notes, ascent/descent rules, ornamentation, and nyas (resting) points. In a raga answer, include its thaat where taught, jati, vadi-samvadi where prescribed, time/mood if required, aroha, avaroha, pakad/chalan, and a short explanation of its identity.

How to practise a raga

Begin with the drone and sing Sa steadily. Sing the aroha and avaroha slowly, then practise the pakad repeatedly. Identify vadi/samvadi and resting notes as taught. Build small phrases before longer elaboration. Sing the bandish with correct words, tala, and sam placement. Record yourself and check whether the raga remains recognisable without relying on the scale alone.

Raga Bhairav

Bhairav is commonly described as a morning raga and is often placed in the Bhairav thaat. Its defining swara colour includes komal Re and komal Dha, typically treated with a distinctive, weighty oscillation in many performance traditions. A commonly taught outline is: aroha Sa re Ga Ma Pa dha Ni Sa; avaroha Sa Ni dha Pa Ma Ga re Sa. Capitalisation and notation of shuddha/komal notes vary by book; here “re” and “dha” indicate komal swaras. The characteristic treatment of Re and Dha matters as much as the note collection.

Bhairav — identity and practice

Practise the komal Re and komal Dha with patience and control; do not sing them as plain, uncoloured notes if your teacher demonstrates an oscillated treatment. Keep Ga, Ma, Pa, and Ni stable and clear. A simple outline is not enough to establish Bhairav: its phrase grammar and serious, meditative character are important. Learn the exact pakad and bandish taught in class, and practise the vilambit and drut presentations assigned by your teacher.

Raga Bageshri

Bageshri is commonly taught as a late-night raga associated with the Kafi thaat. A common classroom outline uses komal Ga and komal Ni, with Ma as a prominent resting/important note. Many standard presentations emphasise the ascent and phrase movement rather than a simple straight scale; Pa may be used sparingly or treated differently by tradition. One commonly taught outline is often represented approximately as: aroha Ni Sa ga Ma Dha Ni Sa; avaroha Sa Ni Dha Ma ga Re Sa, but exact forms and the role of Pa differ across teaching lineages. Use the prescribed aroha, avaroha, and pakad from your teacher/textbook.

Bageshri — identity and practice

The raga's identity often emerges through its gentle, inward, lyrical movement and emphasis on Ma and the characteristic komal swaras. Practise phrases with smooth meend where taught, keeping the raga's characteristic descent and resting points intact. Avoid turning the raga into a generic Kafi-scale exercise. Learn the precise pakad, bandish, and approved note treatment from the classroom version.

Raga Malkauns

Malkauns is commonly associated with late night and the Bhairavi thaat in many modern classification systems, though textbook classification should be followed. It is an audav-audav raga, using five swaras: Sa, komal Ga, shuddha Ma, komal Dha, and komal Ni. A common outline is: aroha Sa ga Ma dha ni Sa; avaroha Sa ni dha Ma ga Sa. Re and Pa are omitted. The raga's identity depends on the weight, repose, and phrase treatment of these five swaras, not merely on omitting two notes.

Malkauns — identity and practice

Keep the swaras spacious and controlled. Do not introduce Re or Pa into the basic raga framework unless a specific taught phrase permits a contextually accepted treatment (for standard school work, follow the prescribed grammar strictly). Practise slow alaps, clear nyas, and the exact bandish. The meditative character often comes from sustained, deliberate phrasing and careful swara intonation.

Compare Bhairav, Bageshri, and Malkauns

Bhairav is associated with the morning and uses komal Re and komal Dha with a distinctive treatment. Bageshri is associated with late night, uses komal Ga and komal Ni, and is shaped by characteristic phrases and emphasis around Ma. Malkauns is a five-note raga omitting Re and Pa, with komal Ga, komal Dha, and komal Ni plus shuddha Ma. These broad cues help distinguish them, but the final test is the phrase grammar taught in class.

What "critical study" means

A critical study is more than listing the scale. Describe the raga's swaras and omissions, characteristic movement, important notes, typical phrases, ornamentation, resting points, mood/time where prescribed, and how it differs from similar ragas. Add one or two illustrative phrases from class notation. Do not claim a phrase is universal if it is specific to a particular gharana.

Bandish notation checklist

Before submitting notation, verify the title, raga, tala, sthayi, antara, lyrics, swara spelling, octave marks, matra placement, sam, and any symbols used by the textbook. Sing while checking the notation; if the written pattern does not align with the taught melody, correct it with your teacher. Never substitute an online bandish simply because it has the same title.

Practical examination preparation

1. Vilambit khayal in two prescribed ragas

Prepare the two ragas assigned by your teacher with the complete vilambit bandish, correct lyrics, tala, sthayi and antara, and a measured alap/vistar appropriate to the raga. Demonstrate the raga's identity before attempting elaborate improvisation. Keep the tempo stable, return to sam confidently, and ensure that bol-alap or taan work does not obscure the composition.

2. Drut khayal in Bhairav, Bageshri, and Malkauns

Learn the prescribed drut bandish for each raga. Practise first at a moderate speed, then at the performance tempo. Keep words intelligible and swaras distinct. Do not rush the mukhda or lose the tala while singing taans. If a taan becomes unclear, simplify it and maintain raga grammar and rhythmic accuracy.

3. Tarana

A tarana uses rhythmic syllables such as tana/deredere-type bols according to the composition and tradition. Learn the exact syllables and melody of the prescribed tarana. Practise pronunciation, rhythmic alignment, and clear return to the mukhda. Do not improvise syllables that alter the taught composition.

4. Dhamar composition

Learn the exact Dhamar composition, its text, melodic shape, and 14-matra tala cycle. Practise the tala separately, then speak the bols, then sing the composition. Maintain the unequal 5+2+3+4 structure and know where sam occurs.

5. Raga identification

For each prescribed raga, memorise the characteristic swaras and phrase. Listen to short examples and identify what makes the raga distinctive: komal/tivra notes, omitted notes, phrase direction, nyas, and ornamentation. Avoid identifying only from mood or time, because those cues are not sufficient on their own.

6. Tala recitation

For Jhaptal, Rupak, and Dhamar, recite the number of matras, vibhag grouping, tali/khali pattern, and theka. Then demonstrate thah, dugun, tigun, and chaugun as required. Keep a steady underlying pulse and return to sam without hesitation.

7. Tanpura and practical file

Be able to identify the instrument's parts, explain its role, tune it according to the setup taught in class, and check the sound by listening. Keep your practical file complete, legible, organised, and aligned with the teacher's format. Include only compositions and notation approved by your teacher.

Daily riyaaz template

1. 5 minutes: posture, relaxed breathing, and comfortable Sa. 2. 10 minutes: slow swara practice and alankars. 3. 10 minutes: raga aroha/avaroha and pakad. 4. 15–20 minutes: assigned bandish with tala. 5. 5–10 minutes: one focused skill (meend, taan clarity, tala recitation, or tanpura tuning). Adapt the duration to your voice and teacher's guidance; stop if there is discomfort or strain.

Mock-viva questions

Define alankar, kan, meend, khatka, murki, gamak, alap, and tana. Explain the difference between alap and tana. What are grama and murchhana in historical theory? What is raga-time theory? Name the authors and importance of Sangeet Ratnakar and Sangeet Parijat. Describe the style and contribution of Faiyaz Khan and Bade Ghulam Ali Khan. State the matras and vibhag patterns of Jhaptal, Rupak, and Dhamar. Explain thah, dugun, tigun, and chaugun. Describe the role and tuning of tanpura. Give the defining features of Bhairav, Bageshri, and Malkauns.

Last-minute revision sheets

Must-memorise tala facts

Jhaptal: 10 matras; grouping 2+3+2+3. Rupak: 7 matras; grouping 3+2+2. Dhamar: 14 matras; grouping 5+2+3+4. Learn the exact theka and hand pattern taught in class, because notation and bol variants occur.

Must-memorise raga cues

Bhairav: morning association; komal Re and komal Dha; characteristic treatment of those swaras. Bageshri: late-night association; komal Ga and komal Ni; characteristic phrases and emphasis around Ma. Malkauns: five swaras; Sa, komal Ga, Ma, komal Dha, komal Ni; Re and Pa omitted in the standard outline.

Answer-writing structure

For a definition: meaning + musical action + purpose + example. For a history question: person/text + period + main subject + importance. For a raga: thaat if prescribed + jati + aroha/avaroha + vadi/samvadi if prescribed + pakad + time/mood + distinguishing feature. For a tala: total matras + vibhag grouping + tali/khali + theka + one sentence about use.

Final verification checklist

Check the current CBSE syllabus and your school's practical list. Confirm the exact biography intended by "Krishna Rao" and "Shankar Pandit." Use your teacher's version of the time-theory chart, raga pakads, bandish lyrics, notation symbols, thekas, and tanpura string order. These details can vary across books and traditions.